

FLEXIBLE SUPPORTS FOR COLLEGE SUCCESS

March 6, 2024

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1

Presenters



Maria Paiewonsky



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2

Overview

- Supported education
- Student engagement in college classes
- Determining accommodation needs (as needed)
- Campus resources
- Intensive supports
- Student perspectives

3

What is Supported Education?

Supported education is the process of helping students with disabilities reach their personal educational goals.

Supported education programs provide encouragement and connect students to resources at their school and in their community.

Temple University Collaborative. (2014). Education goals: A factsheet for providers.



4

**Supported
education is
grounded in 3
principles:**

- (1) Increasing individual skills
- (2) Increasing support from the environment
- (3) Maximizing the fit between the individual and environment



5

Goal

Determining appropriate level of support that leads to student engagement and satisfaction in college classes.

6

Think College research

Academic Supports
35 TPSID programs
494 students

96% of students utilized the disability office services (DSO)

Among them, only **10%** relied solely on DSO for support

The remaining **90%** also receiving assistance from TPSID program staff, faculty, peers, and others

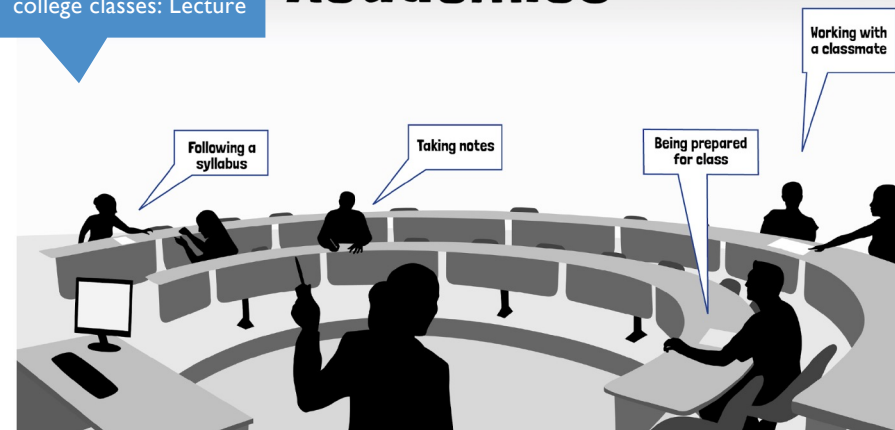
Grigal, M., Hart, D., Papay, C., Bukaty, C., Choiseul-Praslin, B., & Lazo, R. (2023). Annual Report of the Cohort 3 TPSID Model Demonstration Projects (Year 2, 2021–2022). University of Massachusetts Boston, Institute for Community Inclusion.



7

Predominant format of college classes: Lecture

Academics



8



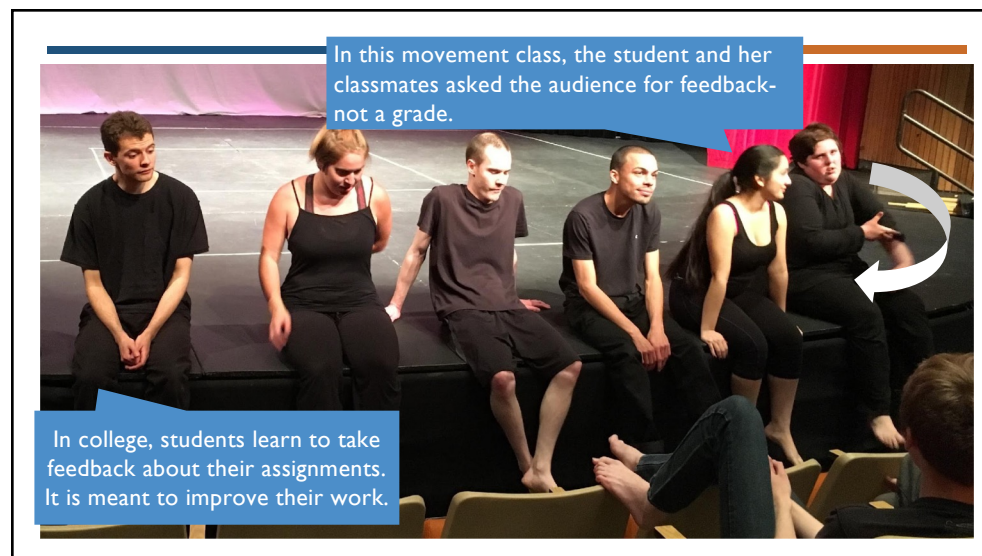
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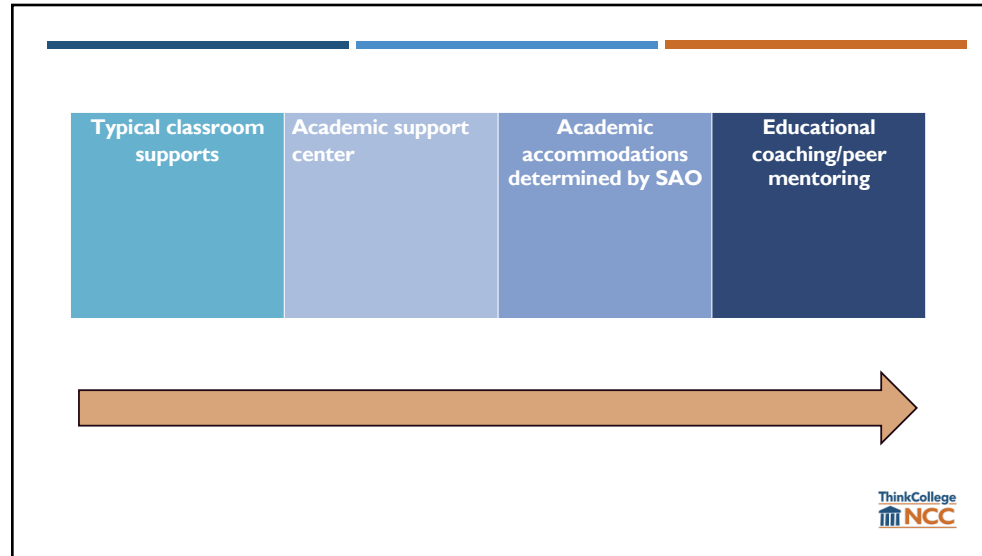
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11



12



13

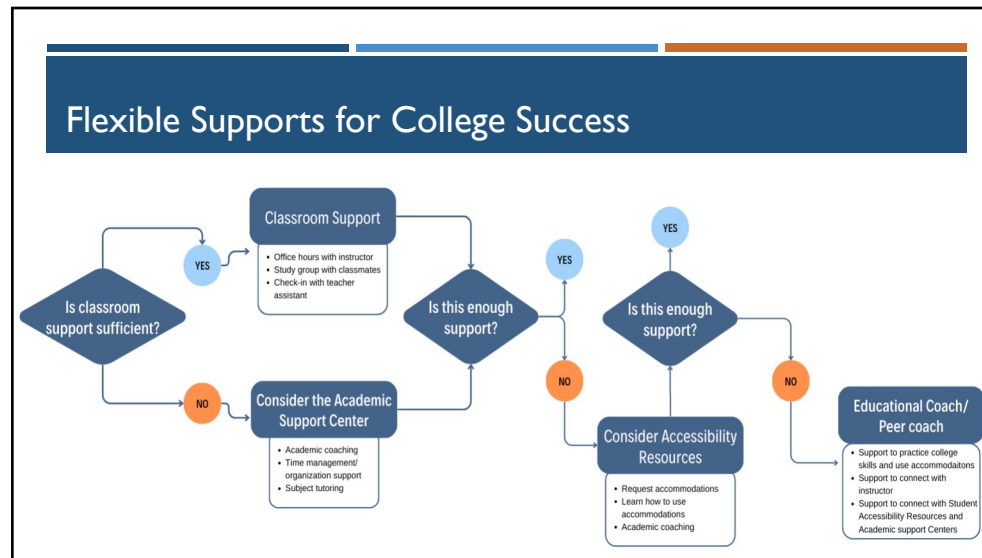
The slide features a dark blue header bar with the title 'Initial Considerations' in white. Below the header, the text 'Information drawn from interviews, Summary of Performance, K-12 documentation.' is displayed in orange. A list of five considerations follows in black text: 'Previous educational experience and disability impact on learning', 'Previous experiences with accommodations', 'Any previous college experience', 'Anticipated course load', and 'Course format and expectations'. The 'ThinkCollege NCC' logo is located in the bottom right corner.

Initial Considerations

Information drawn from interviews, Summary of Performance, K-12 documentation.

- Previous educational experience and disability impact on learning
- Previous experiences with accommodations
- Any previous college experience
- Anticipated course load
- Course format and expectations

14



15

Typical Course Accommodations

- Office hours with instructor
- Check-in with a teacher's assistant
- Classroom specific support
- Study group with classmates

A photograph showing a student in a green shirt sitting at a desk, facing an older male instructor with a beard and glasses. The instructor is gesturing with his hands while speaking. They are in an office with bookshelves in the background.

16

Academic Support Center

Academic coaching

Time management,
organization, study/ test
taking strategies, and note
taking skills

Subject tutoring



17

Student Accessibility Services

Request accommodations

If approved, learn how to use
your accommodations

Discuss accommodations with
instructor as needed

Consider academic coaching

HOW TO
Think College
ISSUE NO. 4, 2018

GETTING
ACCOMMODATIONS TO
SUCCEED AT COLLEGE

Accommodations are supports and services provided at no cost to eligible students with disabilities to have equal access and opportunity to benefit from classes, programs, and activities. Accommodations are different for every student, because every student has unique needs. To request an accommodation, you have to register with the Disability Services Office, or DSO. This office may have a different name on your campus, such as Student Support Services or Office of Accessibility. Your admissions representative or college advisor can help you find the office and make an intake appointment.

In addition to accommodations, talk with a DSO staff member about getting training in assistive technology, or accessing the academic hearing center on campus to connect with a hearing coach. You can also look for a peer mentoring program or student support group to join. Each campus may be a bit different, but staff can recommend the many supports available to students.

COMMON COLLEGE ACCOMMODATIONS				
EXAM MODIFICATIONS				
Extended time	Reader	Scribe	Testing in a quiet room with no distractions	
Note-taking services	Interpreters	Textbooks in an alternate format	Preferential seating	
Use of laptops for tests and exams	Use of calculators for tests and exams	Priority registration for courses	Permission to make audio recordings of classes	Access to audiobooks, voice-recognition software, and text-to-speech programs

The Think College Transition Project is funded by an investment in Innovation Development Grant #2017-2018 from the Office of Innovation and Engagement with matching funds provided by the Peter and Elizabeth C. Swer Foundation.

18

Educational Coach/Peer Mentoring Support

Additional support to:

- Develop college skills
- Follow syllabus/ plan for accommodations
- Check in with instructor as needed
- Check in with Student Accessibility Services, Academic Support Centers



19

Student-Educational Coach Agreement

Student and Coach Names: _____
Semester/Date: _____

Supports	Student Responsibilities	Educational Coach Responsibilities
Transportation to & from campus		
Mobility around campus		
Communication with course instructor(s)		
Meetings with disability services counselor/academic advisor		
Accommodations		
Academic support services		
Free time between classes & at lunch		
Evening & weekend campus activities		
Social connections		
Individual schedule		

Tools: Student-Coach Agreement

- Outlines Student Responsibilities
- Outlines Educational Coach Responsibilities

20

Tools: Syllabus Review Form

Spring 2024 Syllabus Review Form

After attending your first class, meet with your educational coach to complete this form and discuss your course audit plan for the semester.

What are your goals for this class? *

For example) my goal is to review each class lecture after class.

Your answer

Discuss with your ed coach how assignments may need to be changed to support your participation in the class.

Please explain below.

Examples of course alterations)

- *Instead of writing four, 5 page papers--> I will focus on completing two one page papers.*
- *Instead of reading 50 pages a week--> I will read 10 pages a week.*
- *Instead of submitting discussion boards in paragraph form--> I will submit my answers in bullet form*

Assists students review their syllabus
Outlines semester goals/assignments
Outlines support from the ed coach



21

Student Report from UMass Boston

Class: History of Country Music

Educational Coach Support:

class notes
assignments
Exams

Peer Mentor Support:

connecting to campus
clubs/activities



22

Resources

Paiewonsky, M., Mecca, K., Daniels, T., Katz, C., Nash, J., Hanson, T., & Gragoudas, S. (2010). Students and educational coaches: Developing a support plan for college. Think College Insight Brief, Issue No. 4. Boston, MA: University of Massachusetts Boston, Institute for Community Inclusion.

Luce, A. (2024) Syllabus Review Form. Retrieved from:
<https://thinkcollege.net/resource/inclusive-academics/syllabus-review-form>



23

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24